
SCHOOLS

During the early 1900's, the Clearview school had only grades one through eight. One of the first school principals was Mrs. Neva Thompson, the wife of J. E. Thompson. Her greatest desire and ambition was to see that all children received an education.

Attendance at the Clearview School was compulsory for all school-age children. However, employed children were excused as long as they were working. As late as December, the editor of the newspaper (The "Clearview Patriarch") was still urging farm parents to enroll their children in school and keep them there for the remainder of the 1911-12 school term.

In general, the attendance rate for boys, as compared to girls, remained low, with many boys dropping out completely before completing the seventh grade.

Although isolated from the dominant society, Black town school patrons attempted to compete with whites for county funds and the resulting discrimination hindered Blacks' attempts to provide adequate educational facilities and qualified teachers.

J. C. Leftwich was among the few who exploited the Black hunger for education. Leftwich traveled in Oklahoma and surrounding states seeking student funds. Whenever he was confronted with complaints, he was said to have responded - schools are organized to train minds, not appetites.

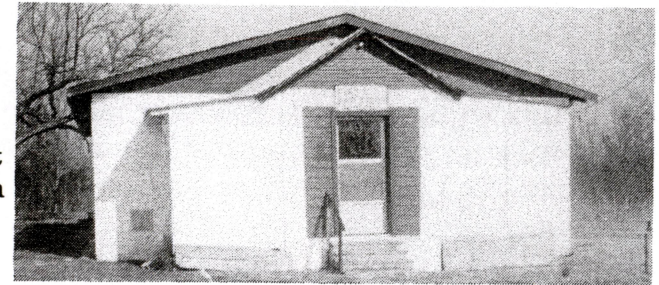
Leftwich came to Clearview in 1914 with one purpose in mind - to establish a college. He purchased an acreage of land on a hill just a short distance Northeast of town. There he began construction.

J. E. Thompson, Clearview's most prominent citizen, appealed to the State Board of Agriculture for funds. Leftwich, meanwhile had assumed the editorship of Thompson's newspaper the "Clearview Patriarch". In addition to advertising the college through its columns, he embarked on a speaking tour

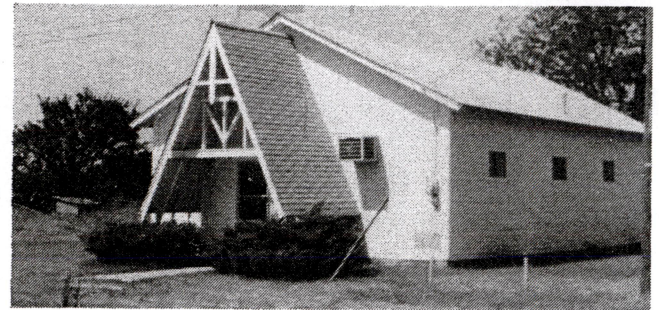
CHURCHES

For many years Clearview boasted of having religious services for all who sought to worship. Such denominations were: The First Baptist, The African Methodist Episcopal (A.M.E.), The Church of Christ, The Church of the Living God, The Christian Church, The Colored Methodist Episcopal (C.M.E.), The Sanctified, and The Holy Roller. Today only the following churches remain; The First Baptist, The African Methodist Episcopal (A.M.E.), and The Church of the Living God.

**First
Baptist
Church**



**Tyree
Chapel
A.M.E.
Church**



**Church
of the
Living
God**

